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FOOD FOR THOUGHT

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What's the ideal IPL diet

With intense travel, late-night matches and pressure, **food becomes fuel**, supplements become strategy, and recovery is everything.

In the IPL, performances are judged by sixes and wickets. But behind every explosive moment is a strategy that starts with breakfast and ends with a probiotic before bed.

As a sports nutritionist who's worked with cricketers like Virat Kohli, Robin Uthappa and Shikhar Dhawan, I've seen how diet transforms a season. With intense travel, late-night matches and pressure, food becomes fuel, supplements become strategy, and recovery is everything.

This isn't generic advice. Every plan here is tailored using genetic tests, gut data, and blood markers — giving players exactly what their body needs.

Here's a detailed walk-through of a match day, practice day, travel day, and rest day nutrition plan — with Indian, continental, and athlete-friendly global food options.

Wake-Up Phase

Players often wake up late due to fatigue from the previous night's match. The day starts with jeera water, glutamine, and L-carnitine — a mix that supports the digestive system, boosts energy metabolism, and reduces inflammation.

Fasted light mobility drills improve insulin sensitivity and alertness.

Breakfast

The first solid meal provides sustained energy while keeping digestion easy.

Indian options:

- ✦ Onion uttapam with sambar
- ✦ Two dosas with coconut chutney
- ✦ Stuffed paneer paratha with curd

Continental options:

- ✦ Scrambled eggs on multigrain toast
- ✦ Greek yoghurt with muesli and berries
- ✦ Protein smoothie (banana, almond milk, oats, chia seeds)